

M1 | **Placement Foundations** for B-Schools Course Curriculum

Placement Foundations for B-Schools

4 Self-paced Modules, 28 Lectures

Industry-agnostic Interview essentials for all MBA placements, covering detailed structured problem solving and its applications in interviews, behavioural interviews, leadership principles, professional conduct & communication, and interview strategy for business roles across Growth, Category, Marketing, Operations, Product Management, Business Analytics, Customer Experience, and General Management

#	Module	Module Contents	#Lectures
1	Structured Problem Solving & Functional Applications	Covers Structured Problem Solving methodologies and their applications across various business scenarios across varied industries in verticals like Growth, Category, Marketing, Operations, Product Management, Business Analytics, Customer Experience, and General Management	10
2	Behavioural Assessment, Leadership Principles, & General Management	Covers the leadership principles and behavioural competencies evaluated across business interviews, including evidence-based storytelling, leadership experiences, stakeholder management, professional judgement, communication, and behavioural interview strategy. Includes detailed Question compendiums for various professional qualities assessed commonly across organizations	7
3	Navigating HR & Hiring Manager Interviews	Covers the objectives, evaluation criteria and interview strategies across HR and hiring manager interviews, including recruiter expectations, career motivation, professional judgement, executive communication and handling challenging interview situations	5
4	Interview Excellence & Placement Readiness	Covers the essential strategies for interview preparation and placement success, including focused company and role research, CV positioning, interview mindset, professional presence, group discussions performance, placement-day execution, and interview best practices	6

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Module 1: Structured Problem Solving & Functional Applications

Covers Structured Problem Solving methodologies and their applications across Growth, Category, Marketing, Operations, Product Management, Business Analytics, Customer Experience, and General Management interview scenarios

#	Lecture	Topics Covered
1	Methods of Structured Problem Solving & Hypothesis-Driven Thinking	Problem decomposition, inductive and deductive reasoning, top-down and bottom-up approaches, MECE principle, issue trees, logic trees, five-whys, root cause analysis, process mapping, hypothesis generation, hypothesis testing
2	Classical Business Frameworks & Their Applications	Pareto Principle, Process Mapping, Value Chain Analysis, Ansoff Matrix, SWOT Analysis, Marketing Mix, framework selection and functional applications
3	Problem Solving Examples: Growth & Marketing	Diagnosing sales decline, improving market share, customer acquisition, customer retention, channel expansion, competitive response, demand drivers, segmentation, growth levers
4	Problem Solving Examples: Revenue, Pricing & Category Management	Pricing decisions, revenue optimization, discounts, product mix decisions, pricing strategy, category management, commercial trade-offs
5	Problem Solving Examples: Cost Optimisation	Cost optimisation, identifying cost drivers, process efficiency, waste reduction, value capture, resource utilisation
6	Problem Solving Examples: Operations & Process Excellence	Improving operational efficiency, inventory optimisation, supply chain diagnostics, resource allocation, service quality improvement, operational trade-offs
7	Problem Solving Examples: Product Management	User journey analysis, customer personas, product metrics, activation, engagement, retention, product-market fit, feature prioritisation
8	Problem Solving Examples: Customer Success & Experience	Customer onboarding, customer adoption, customer engagement, customer retention, customer satisfaction, service recovery, customer experience optimisation
9	Problem Solving Examples: General & Program Management	Cross-functional execution, stakeholder management, prioritisation, execution planning, dependency management, resource coordination, decision making under ambiguity
10	Integrated Business Problem Solving	Interconnected nature of business problems, identifying cross-functional dependencies, selecting the appropriate problem-solving approach, integrating multiple business functions, structured recommendations, end-to-end business problem solving

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Module 2: Behavioural Assessment, Leadership Principles, & General Management

Covers the leadership principles and behavioural competencies evaluated across business interviews, including evidence-based storytelling, leadership experiences, stakeholder management, professional judgement, communication, and behavioural interview strategy. Includes detailed Question compendiums for various professional qualities assessed commonly across organizations

#	Lecture	Topics Covered
1	Decoding Behavioural Interviews & Recruiter Expectations	Behavioural interview methodology, leadership competencies, interviewer evaluation criteria, competency mapping, identifying leadership experiences, evidence-based storytelling, STAR methodology
2	Building High-Impact Leadership Stories	Story selection, story structuring, ownership, initiative, decision making, conflict resolution, overcoming challenges, communicating impact, quantifying achievements
3	Leadership, Stakeholder Management & Professional Judgement	Stakeholder management, influencing without authority, collaboration, difficult conversations, conflict management, decision making under uncertainty, professional judgement, business ethics
4	Driving Results Through Ownership & Execution	Ownership, accountability, bias for action, prioritization, execution excellence, resilience, learning agility, managing ambiguity, handling setbacks
5	Customer Orientation, Innovation & Business Impact	Customer-centric thinking, innovation, continuous improvement, customer obsession, business judgement, strategic thinking, long-term decision making, delivering business impact
6	Learning Agility, Growth Mindset & Continuous Improvement	Learning agility, growth mindset, curiosity, adaptability, seeking feedback, resilience, continuous improvement, experimentation, reflective learning, self-development
7	Building Trust, Integrity & Professional Credibility	Integrity, trust, transparency, accountability, ethical decision making, earning trust, professional credibility, judgement under pressure, handling difficult situations, authenticity

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Module 3: Navigating HR & Hiring Manager Interviews

Covers the objectives, evaluation criteria and interview strategies across HR and hiring manager interviews, including recruiter expectations, career motivation, professional judgement, executive communication and handling challenging interview situations

#	Lecture	Topics Covered
1	Understanding HR & Hiring Manager Interviews	Recruitment process, objectives of each interview stage, HR vs hiring manager expectations, evaluation criteria, interview flow, decision-making process
2	Communicating Career Motivation & Professional Fit	Tell Me About Yourself, Why MBA, Why this company, Why this role, career goals, career transitions, organization fit, long-term aspirations
3	Handling Challenging HR Questions with Confidence	Strengths, weaknesses, failures, conflicts, career gaps, low academic performance, job switches, pressure questions and more
4	Professional Presence & Executive Communication	Executive presence, confidence, articulation, body language, listening skills, professional etiquette, handling interruptions, asking thoughtful questions
5	Recruiter Expectations, Common Mistakes & Final Selection Decisions	Common interview mistakes, authenticity, consistency, closing the interview, interview etiquette, offer decision factors

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Module 4: Interview Excellence & Placement Readiness

Covers the essential strategies for interview preparation and placement success, including focused company and role research, CV positioning, interview mindset, professional presence, group discussions performance, placement-day execution, and interview best practices

#	Lecture	Topics Covered
1	Strategic Company & Role Research	Company business model, products and services, industry landscape, company values and leadership principles, recent developments, role expectations, job descriptions, functional competencies, tailoring interview preparation to the company and role
2	Leveraging Your CV as a Strategic Asset	Reading your CV like a recruiter, resume walkthrough, anchoring interview conversations, highlighting achievements, handling weak sections, tailoring examples, linking experiences to role requirements
3	Interview Mindset, Professional Presence & Etiquette	Confidence building, growth mindset, resilience, performing under pressure, executive presence, body language, communication, professional appearance, interview etiquette, virtual interview etiquette
4	Group Discussions & Collaborative Assessments	GD formats, evaluation criteria, structuring arguments, entering discussions, influencing discussions, collaboration, summarizing discussions, common mistakes
5	Interview Success Playbook: Common Mistakes & Best Practices	Frequent interview mistakes, consistency across interviews, authenticity, preparation pitfalls, post-interview etiquette, interview best practices
6	Placement Week Playbook & Final Revision	Placement-day strategy, revision checklist, interview scheduling, prioritization, logistics, energy management, final preparation checklist



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Curriculum Update Policy: This brochure was last updated on **18 July 2026**. The curriculum, lectures, case studies, and learning resources are periodically reviewed and enhanced to ensure continued relevance with current industry practices and recruitment trends. All enrolled students receive access to all future curriculum updates and newly released course content.

Other EdgeX Courses for you

M2 | **ConsultPro** for B-Schools Course Curriculum

ConsultPro for B-Schools

5 Self-paced Modules, 32 Lectures

A complete prep program for Management Consulting and Strategy interviews at premier B-Schools, covering Case Interviews, Guesstimates, Structured thinking & Business Problem Solving, essential consulting frameworks, industry value chains, consulting communication & interview demonstrations by senior corporate professionals from Tier-1 B-Schools

#	Module	Module Contents	#Lectures
1	Business Foundations & Value Chains, Structured Problem Solving and Core Strategic Frameworks	Develop the structured thinking and analytical toolkit needed in consulting and strategy roles. Learn MECE principles, issue trees, hypothesis-driven problem solving, benchmarking, income statement analysis, and core business frameworks including Porter's Five Forces, Value Chain, BCG Matrix, the Pareto Principle and more. The module also covers industry value chains and applies these concepts to practical business scenarios.	8
2	Case Interview Excellence	Master the structured approach to solving consulting case interviews across profitability, market entry, growth strategy, pricing, operations, M&A, and other common business scenarios. Learn how to ask insightful clarifying questions, develop robust frameworks, synthesize findings, and communicate recommendations with the confidence expected by top consulting firms.	7
3	Guesstimates & Quantitative Reasoning	Develop a systematic approach to tackling estimation problems using logical assumptions, structured decomposition, and quantitative reasoning. Learn proven techniques to solve market sizing and guesstimate questions while clearly communicating your thought process under interview conditions.	5
4	Consulting Readiness & Executive Presence	Go beyond case solving to develop the professional skills expected of successful consulting candidates. Learn networking strategies, interview etiquette, executive communication, and stakeholder management while understanding how to navigate the consulting recruitment process. The module also includes advanced storytelling techniques to help MBA students effectively present their summer internships, prior work experience, leadership roles, live projects, and business school experiences in interviews.	3
5	Interview Demonstrations through Mock Sessions	Observe consulting interview demonstrations with guest IIM/ISB alum interviewers featuring case interviews & guesstimates. Learn correct styles of communication through Case diagnostics and guesstimate solutions. Communication techniques to demonstrate structured thinking, avoid common mistakes, and navigate real interview scenarios with confidence.	9

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Module 1: Business Foundations & Value Chains, Structured Problem Solving and Core Strategic Frameworks

Build the structured thinking and analytical toolkit used in consulting interviews. Learn core business fundamentals, strategic frameworks, hypothesis-driven problem solving, and industry value chains.

#	Lecture	Topics Covered
1	Business Fundamentals for Consultants	Business models, understanding how businesses create value, industry ecosystem, key business functions, frameworks for understanding a business end-to-end and preparing clarifying questions
2	Business Performance Assessment	Income statement, balance sheet, cash flow statement, understanding business performance, key financial metrics, interpreting financial information
3	Methods of Structured Problem Solving & Hypothesis-Driven Thinking	Inductive & Deductive Reasoning, First-Principle thinking, MECE principle, issue trees & factor maps, five-whys, root cause analysis, top-down and bottom-up approaches, hypothesis generation, hypothesis testing
4	Structured Problem Solving in Business Scenarios – I	Problem framing, identifying key business drivers, structuring ambiguous business problems, selecting appropriate approaches
5	Structured Problem Solving in Business Scenarios – II	Business diagnostics, prioritisation, developing recommendations, communicating structured solutions
6	Core Strategic Frameworks & Their Applications	Benchmarking, Pareto Principle, Porter’s Five Forces, BCG Matrix, Ansoff Matrix, SWOT Analysis, framework selection and applications
7	Industry Value Chains I: Manufacturing & Consumer Industries	Process mapping & Value chain analysis, applications across manufacturing, FMCG, retail, e-commerce, consumer businesses, identifying value creation across industries
8	Industry Value Chains II: Services & Technology Industries	Value chains and problem solving applications across telecommunications, pharmaceuticals, financial services, technology, identifying industry-specific business drivers

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Module 2: Case Interview Excellence

Master the structured approach to solving consulting case interviews across common business scenarios. Learn to ask insightful clarifying questions, develop robust frameworks, and develop executive-level recommendations.

#	Lecture	Topics Covered
1	Understanding the Consulting Case Interview	Case interview structure, interviewer expectations, clarifying questions, note-taking, problem structuring, framework selection, hypothesis-driven approach, case flow
2	Profitability Cases	Revenue drivers, cost drivers, margin analysis, pricing impact, product mix, profitability diagnostics, profit improvement
3	Market Entry & Growth Strategy Cases	Market attractiveness, market entry strategies, market expansion, growth opportunities, competitive response, strategic trade-offs
4	Pricing & Commercial Strategy Cases	Pricing frameworks, pricing decisions, customer segmentation, discounts, revenue optimisation, commercial trade-offs
5	Operations & Supply Chain Cases	Procurement, manufacturing, product development, supply chain, logistics, operational efficiency, value capture
6	M&A & Business Transformation Cases	Acquisition rationale, synergy assessment, post-merger integration, organisational transformation, restructuring, change management
7	Unconventional Case Interviews	Ambiguous business problems, open-ended case questions, creative problem solving, innovation and product strategy cases, public sector & social impact cases, digital transformation cases, thinking beyond traditional frameworks

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Module 3: Guesstimates & Quantitative Reasoning

Learn the systematic approach to solving estimation problems using structured thinking and quantitative reasoning. Learn proven techniques for market sizing, logical assumptions, and communicating your thought process with confidence.

#	Lecture	Topics Covered
1	Introduction to Guesstimates & Estimation Methodologies	Interview expectations, estimation mindset, structured decomposition, top-down approach, bottom-up approach, bottleneck (constraint) approach, hybrid estimation techniques
2	Building Assumptions & Quantitative Reasoning	Logical assumptions, approximation techniques, mental math, ratios, percentages, growth rates, validating assumptions, sanity checks
3	Consumer & Market Sizing Guesstimates	Population-based estimation, customer segmentation, demand estimation, consumption-based guesstimates, market sizing problems
4	Business & Operational Guesstimates	Capacity estimation, production, supply chain, logistics, infrastructure, resource planning, operational estimation problems
5	Advanced & Unconventional Guesstimates	Multi-layered estimation problems, ambiguous guesstimates, business judgement, combining estimation methodologies, interviewer-led pivots, creative problem solving

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Module 4: Consulting Readiness & Executive Presence

Develop the professional skills required to succeed in consulting recruitment. Learn networking styles, executive communication, and advanced storytelling techniques for consulting interviews

#	Lecture	Topics Covered
1	Consulting Recruitment Strategy & Networking	Consulting recruitment landscape, recruitment timelines, networking strategies, buddy conversations, coffee chats, referrals, firm research, consulting career pathways
2	Executive Presence & Professional Communication	Executive communication, structured communication, professional presence, interview etiquette, consulting professionalism, stakeholder management
3	Strategic Profile Positioning for Consulting	Positioning your CV for consulting, leveraging prior work experience, highlighting internships and live projects, building a consulting narrative, demonstrating impact through achievements, aligning your profile with consulting expectations

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Module 5: Interview Demonstrations through Mock Sessions

Observe end-to-end consulting interview demonstrations featuring case interviews and guesstimates, conducted by senior corporate professionals and Tier-1 B-school alumni. Learn the communication style expected in consulting interviews, asking effective clarifying questions, interpreting interviewer cues, structuring your responses, and applying interview best practices

#	Lecture	Topics Covered
1	Case Interview Demonstration I	• Interview demonstration featuring mock interviews with senior corporate professionals and Tier-1 B-school alums. Observe consulting communication style, asking effective clarifying questions, interpreting interviewer cues, structuring responses, case diagnostics, and interview best practices.
2	Case Interview Demonstration II	
3	Case Interview Demonstration III	
4	Case Interview Demonstration IV	
5	Case Interview Demonstration V	
6	Guesstimate Demonstration I	
7	Guesstimate Demonstration II	
8	Guesstimate Demonstration III	
9	Guesstimate Demonstration IV	



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